

Week 4 Enabling Activities

Hypothetical & Conditional

This set covers the full six-activity family for Hypothetical & Conditional, organized as two tracks: 1a–1c build the Condition → Projected Outcome → Extended Scenario move in stages; 4a–4c test whether it has proceduralized. These supplement — they do not replace — this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

This Week's Frame — Hypothetical & Conditional (W4)

Condition	Projected Outcome	Extended Scenario
What must hold for this scenario to follow?	What would likely result?	And if that outcome holds, then what?

Key requirement: the extended scenario must go one step beyond the projected outcome. A response that states the condition and the immediate result but stops there is only two-thirds of the move — the frame requires projecting what happens next, after that first outcome takes hold.

Activity Index

1a. Single-Scenario Depth Ladder · 1b. Sentence-Frame Progression · 1c. 3-Interval Comparison & Paraphrase · 4a. 2-Box Induction · 4b. Silent Protocol & Brief-Back · 4c. Strategic Competence & Fallback

Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Condition → Projected Outcome → Extended Scenario move in four steps. Use before a student's first W4 attempt, or as remediation if responses stop at the first outcome.

ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ALL FOUR ITEMS)

A country lowers its voting age to 16.

1

Surface

"If a country lowers its voting age to 16, what is the condition, exactly?"

State the condition precisely — what has to actually be true.

2

Surface → Deep

"What would likely result immediately from that condition?"

Add the Projected Outcome box. First-order result only — stop here for now.

3

Deep

"If the voting age drops to 16, more young people would likely vote in that first election. And if that higher turnout holds over several elections, then ____."

Complete the Extended Scenario — the second-order consequence, one step further than the first outcome.

4

Transfer

"What would happen if countries made voting mandatory for all adults?"

Full response: condition + projected outcome + extended scenario, no connector given.

Instructor note: 5–10 minute warm-up. A student who completes Item 4 without hesitation is ready for the Week 4 folder.

Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Appositive

Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded — and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision.

SCENARIO

A country lowers its voting age to 16.

T1

Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one condition-to-outcome link.

- "Turnout among young voters would likely rise given that ____."
- "Election officials are willing to lower the voting age on the grounds that ____."
- "Some critics remain skeptical of the change considering that ____."

T2

Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Hold the immediate outcome and the extended scenario in tension inside one sentence.

- "While younger voters might turn out modestly in the first election, the long-term effect ____."
- "Although the immediate outcome seems small, the extended scenario ____."
- "Even though critics doubt any short-term impact, sustained turnout over several elections ____."

T3

Appositives — "Fact, ____, Fact"

Embed a condition's or scenario's role in the projection as a defining phrase inside the sentence.

MODEL

"The lowered voting age, the initial condition that opens the door to younger participation, produces a modest bump in first turnout, while the extended pattern of civic habit-forming, compounding across several election cycles, eventually reshape issues campaigns prioritize."

Instructor note: 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' — same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. T3 stretch — optional for students still consolidating the core requirement.

Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects conditional-projection vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that explicitly extends one step past the first outcome.

COMPARISON PAIR

How the voting age policy's first-election outcome compares with its extended effect across several election cycles.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

contingent
on

were
[X] to
occur

in turn

absent
[X]

downstream

- 1

Surface
"In one sentence, compare the immediate outcome of lowering the voting age with its extended effect over several elections."
- 2

Deep
"Using contingent on, explain what the extended scenario depends on beyond the first election's turnout."
- 3

Transfer
"Write one complex sentence connecting the projected outcome to the extended scenario, using in turn or downstream."

Instructor note: score for lexicon use and whether the extended scenario genuinely goes one step beyond the first outcome — not for stance on lowering the voting age.

Visual Synthesis

Forces students to notice when a conditional claim's condition has gone unstated from grouped, unlabeled examples — no rule is stated up front.

Box A

- If the city extends the subway line into the suburbs, downtown traffic would likely ease during rush hour.
- If schools eliminate standardized testing, teachers would likely have more flexibility in lesson planning.
- If the company adopts a four-day week, employee retention would likely improve.

Box B

- Downtown traffic would likely ease during rush hour.
- Teachers would likely have more flexibility in lesson planning.
- Employee retention would likely improve.

TASK

Box B's claims could just as easily be simple predictions about the future — nothing marks them as conditional reasoning. What is missing from Box B that Box A has? Why does naming the condition explicitly matter for this week's frame, even when the outcome itself is easy to guess?

Instructor note: this is a common failure mode at ILR 2+: students describe a plausible future without ever grounding it in the 'if' that makes it conditional reasoning rather than a guess. Let the student name what's missing before you confirm it.

Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response.

PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Three elements are marked [A], [B], [C]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] If the country lowers its voting age to sixteen — a change that would immediately add several million newly eligible voters to the rolls before the next election — [B] turnout among that age group would likely be modest at first, since first-time voters historically participate at lower rates than experienced ones regardless of age. [C] But if those sixteen-year-olds vote even once before adulthood, research on civic habit-forming suggests they become measurably more likely to vote for the rest of their lives — meaning the policy's real effect wouldn't show up in the first election at all, but in the turnout data twenty years later.

Key (reveal only after Phase 2). In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.



[A] =
Condition



[B] =
Projected
Outcome



[C] =
Extended
Scenario

PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud — or write in one sentence — your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan.

PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"What would happen if the voting age were lowered to sixteen only for local city elections, not national ones?"

Instructor note: the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal — keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary — the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available.

CONSTRAINT

Answer the prompt below without using the words condition, projected outcome, or extended scenario.

PROMPT

"What would happen if countries made voting mandatory for all adults?"

Fallback Strategies to Practice

a

Circumlocution

Instead of "condition," try "what has to be true first" or "the starting point."

b

Term substitution

Instead of "projected outcome" / "extended scenario," try "what happens right away" / "what happens after that, over time."

c

Self-correction

"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d

Hedging

"It seems likely that..." / "This could eventually lead to..."

Instructor note: use after a student is reliably using the frame vocabulary — this is a stress test, not a first attempt.